Liu Yumin

The University of Hong Kong, Pokfulam, Hong Kong | yuminliu@connect.hku.hk | +852 53446797 |

Education

The University of Hong Kong, PhD Candidate in Philosophy Dec 2022 – present
(expected completion: Dec 2026)

- **Research interests:** formal epistemology; Bayesian epistemology; decision theory; philosophy of AI
- **Supervisor:** Prof. Simon Goldstein
- **Doctoral thesis:** *A Decision-Theoretic Analysis of Belief and Inquiry*

University of St Andrews, MLitt in Philosophy Sep 2021 – Nov 2022

- **Areas of study:** political and moral philosophy; formal epistemology
- **Master's dissertation:** *Abortion, Relationships, and Responsibility in Gestation*

Peking University, Bachelor of Philosophy Sep 2017 – Jun 2021

- **Areas of study:** ancient Western philosophy; Aristotelian philosophy
- **Undergraduate dissertation:** *The Definition and Particularity of Primary Substances in Aristotle*

Selected Honors, Scholarships, and Distinctions

- **Postgraduate Research Scholarship** (2022–2026); **MLitt awarded with Merit**, University of St Andrews (2022); **Outstanding Graduate**, Yuanpei College (2021); **Mingde Scholarship** (2017–2020; top 0.01%).
- **PKU Major Award** (2017; first-ranked entrant from Guizhou Province, 1 of approximately 410,000 candidates); Social Work Award, Peking University (2018); Third Prize, Guanghua School of Management Winter Vacation Practical Investigation (2018).

Publications

- Liu, Y. "Prior Adjustments and Moral Encroachment on Credences." *Synthese* 208, 119 (2026). doi:10.1007/s11229-026-05770-z
- Liu, Y. "Procreation and Moral Reasons: Balancing Prerogatives and Harm." *Inquiry*. **Accepted for publication**.

Research

PhD Research, The University of Hong Kong Dec 2022 – present

- *Suspension as Delay: Toward a Decision-Theoretic Credal Theory* (under review)
- *Inquiry, Supererogation, and Zetetic Norms* (under review)
- *Belief Stability and Action Stability* (draft in progress)
- *The Topology of AI Alignment: How Human–AI Network Structure Shapes Collective Reliability* (With Lin Li, accepted workshop paper, NeurIPS 2026 BiAlign)
- *Personal Assistant or Community Oracle? A Bayesian View of the Effectiveness of Shared AI Advice* (With Lin Li and Boris Babic, under review)

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, The University of Hong Kong (HKU) *PHIL7001 (A,B,C) Fundamentals of AI, Data and Algorithms* Sep 2026 – Dec 2026

- **Tutorial leadership:** Will lead weekly sessions on philosophical issues in AI, data, and algorithms, integrating conceptual analysis with technical course content.
- **Student support:** Will guide discussion, clarify course materials, and provide academic mentoring.

Lecturer, Lingnan University *CCC8011 Critical Thinking: Analysis and Argumentation* Sep 2026 – Dec 2026

- **Teaching delivery:** Will deliver lectures and facilitate in-class debates on argument analysis, reasoning, and critical thinking.
- **Course development:** Will collaborate with the teaching team to develop course materials and coordinate teaching activities.

Teaching Assistant, HKU *CCAI9002 Thinking Machines: Philosophical and Ethical Explorations* Jan 2026 – May 2026

- **Tutorial leadership:** Led three weekly tutorial sessions on philosophical and ethical issues in AI.
- **Curriculum support:** Developed discussion materials and reflection questions to promote critical engagement with course content.

Lecturer, HKU *PHIL2100: Paradoxes of Decision* Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- **Independent course design:** Designed and delivered a 12-week lecture course on decision theory, covering rational choice theory, expected utility theory, social choice theory, game theory, and evolutionary game theory.
- **Assessment:** Evaluated weekly assignments, midterm essays, and final essays and provided substantive feedback.

Teaching Assistant, Peking University (PKU), *Western Philosophy II* Sep 2020 – Jan 2021

- **Seminar leadership:** Led discussions on major figures and topics in early modern philosophy, including Descartes, Leibniz, Locke, Hume, and Kant.
- **Assessment and support:** Assisted with grading and feedback for 80+ student essays and coordinated weekly Q&A sessions.

Conferences (Peer-Reviewed)

NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Bidirectional Human–AI Alignment (BiAlign) Dec 11–12, 2026

- Scheduled to present *The Topology of AI Alignment: How Human–AI Network Structure Shapes Collective Reliability* at this peer-reviewed workshop.

The Asian Epistemology Network Meeting 2026 (Zhejiang University) Nov 2026

- Scheduled to present *Inquiry, Supererogation, and Zetetic Norms*.

The 7th International Young Scholars Workshop on Science and Philosophy (Shanghai Jiao Tong University) Jun 2025

- Presented *Prior Adjustments and Moral Encroachment*.

The 2nd Beijing International Conference in Analytic Philosophy (Beijing Normal University) Jul 2024

- Presented *Procreation Asymmetry and Moral Reasons: Balancing Prerogatives and Harm*.

Academic Service and Activities

PKU Classical Studies Program, Student Assistant

- **Editorial and international engagement:** Co-edited Peking University's *Classical Studies* and participated in academic exchanges in Paris.

Student Assistant, PKU Humanities Faculty Office

- **Data management:** Improved faculty workflows through Excel-based data processing and reporting systems.
- **Academic event support:** Assisted in organizing the *Peking University Humanities Lecture Series*.

Reception Group Volunteer, The 24th World Congress of Philosophy

- **Academic liaison:** Supported international scholars through liaison and event coordination.
- **Program support:** Assisted with guest reception and academic program arrangements.

Peking University Social Survey Team: Urban Dynamics in China's "Middle Triangle" Region

- **Data analysis:** Analyzed the environmental effects of China's River Chief System and water infrastructure using 180+ government and academic datasets.
- **Policy research:** Collaborated with local governments and research institutions across three cities on water governance and environmental management.

Skills

Languages: Mandarin and Cantonese (Native); English (Professional proficiency); Ancient Greek and Latin (Intermediate); German and French (Basic proficiency)

Programming and computational methods: Python for data analysis (Pandas, NumPy, and Matplotlib); Excel-based data processing

Formal and quantitative methods: probability theory; Bayesian methods; statistics; linear algebra; familiarity with measure theory

Research and typesetting tools: LaTeX; Microsoft Office